# human cell

Smallest living structure and constituent unit of human beings; the sizes and shapes of cells vary according to their function.

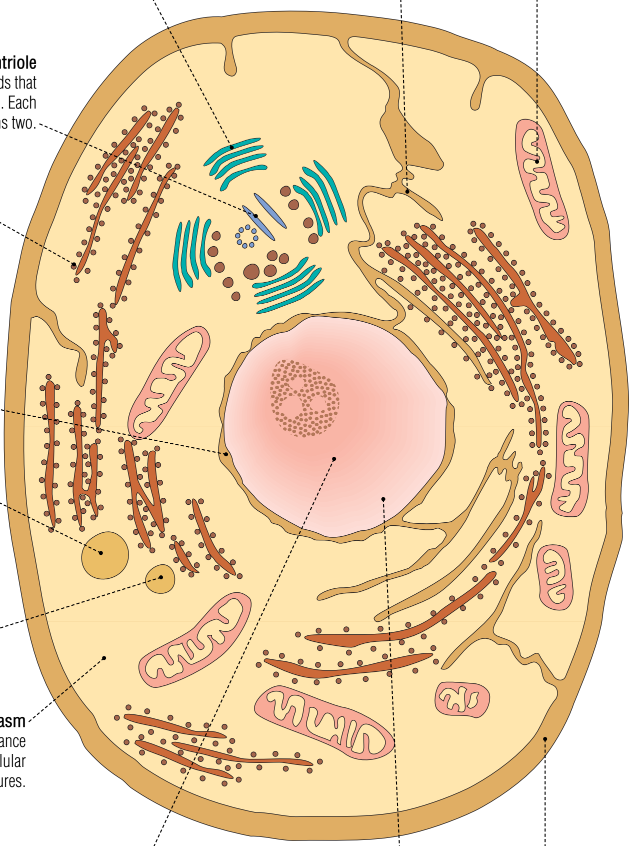
**Golgi apparatus**
Organelle composed of a series of pockets that receive proteins produced by the ribosomes and either transport them outside the cell or to other organelles.

**endoplasmic reticulum**
Organelle formed of walls to which the ribosomes are attached.

**mitochondrion**
Ovoid organelle that produces the energy necessary for cell activity.

**centriole**
Structure consisting of small rods that play a major role in cell division. Each cell usually contains two.

**ribosome**
Organelle, free or attached to the endoplasmic reticulum, producing proteins essential to the constitution and functioning of living beings.



**nuclear envelope**
Envelope formed of two layers surrounding the nucleus and pierced with small holes, which allow exchanges between the cytoplasm and the nucleus.

**lysosome**
Small spheroid organ containing enzymes that break down food, spent cell components and other harmful substances that have been absorbed.

**vacuole**
Spherical cavity containing water, waste and various substances required by the cell.

**cytoplasm**
Clear gelatinous substance surrounding the various cellular structures.

**chromatin**
Mass of very fine filaments of DNA, the genetic material of the cell; it is compressed into chromosomes during cell division.

**nucleus**
Organelle containing a cell's genes and controlling its activities.

**cell membrane**
The cell's flexible outer casing; it separates the cell from the surrounding environment and works as a filter to control the entry and exit of certain substances.